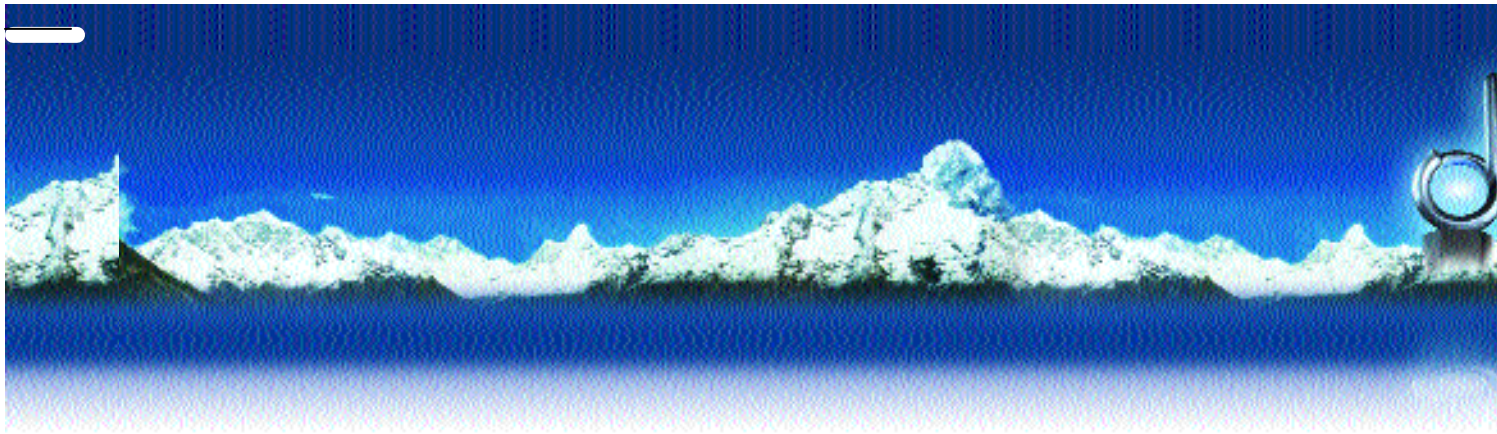
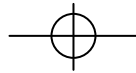




INPUT DEVICES

The ubiquitous mouse and the keyboard are our real interfaces into the digital world. Though there have been numerous suggestions for more advanced forms of getting information into the computer all through the years, there is no device that has quite matched the convenience that the keyboard and mouse offers—even after the arrival of such tools as speech recognition.

Pushing the right buttons

Input devices are broadly characterised by their interface, functionality, ergonomics and the technology used. In the case of keyboards, the best kinds are those that offer good features and are comfortable to type on. If you use many multimedia applications such as audio and video players, look for a keyboard that offers many function keys with programmable buttons for specialised tasks. Go for one with a USB interface.

Wireless radio-frequency (RF) or infrared keyboards eliminate the tangle of wires on your desktop. Opt for the RF kind since they offer the freedom of being anywhere in the room, and not necessarily in the line of sight of the computer to be able to use them.

The most important performance characteristic of a mouse is the resolution (in dpi) and the sampling rate—



Logitech Cordless Freedom Optical Keyboard
Logitech, Ph: 022-26427501

The verdict: Using a wireless RF technology, this keyboard offers a hassle free interface to your computer. It sports a good design, with responsive keys and plenty of shortcuts for accessing often-used applications



this decides the smoothness of the response. Choose a rating of at least 1000 dpi and a sampling rate of at least 1000 Hz. Avoid mice based on a serial interface as these support low sampling rates. Look for additional buttons for added functionality in working with applications. For performance, choose an optical mouse over a roller mouse as the former is far smoother and requires less maintenance. Finally, try it out for feel and make sure that it is comfortable in your hands and offers enough tactile response.



Microsoft Wireless IntelliMouse Explorer
Microsoft Corporation
India Pvt Ltd,
Ph: 011-26292640

The verdict: Using the tried and tested optical sensor, this mouse takes full advantage of wireless advantage with a very cool and comfortable styling

And the award goes to...

Sporting a great looking design and colour combination, the Logitech Cordless Freedom Keyboard is easily the key of the year. It has an array of buttons to control your multimedia applications and has shortcut keys and application keys for accessing specific features of your programs. The keys are ergonomically placed and are tactile and responsive.

The mouse voted to be the best in its category is the Microsoft Wireless IntelliMouse Explorer. Using optical sensor technology, this mouse features programmable buttons that can be used to navigate through applications and control various functions in games. It gives you accurate control without the hassle on your desktop.

VECTOR GRAPHICS/ILLUSTRATION

CorelDRAW 11

One of the best illustration software has just got better—CorelDRAW 11 has some amazing new features and functionality, making it one of the most powerful vector drawing applications. Its numerous drawing tools let you create a variety of elements, and the customisable toolbars and menus with individual macros can be saved to specific workspaces. The cross-platform functionality lets you work with files from different sources and the import/export filters make this task simple. The three-point drawing tools let you create a variety of curves and shapes with a minimum number of clicks. Tools such as Weld, Trim and Intersect allow speed and efficiency when working with a variety of objects in a single drawing. You can also save shapes and drawings that you've

created as 'symbols', which can then be saved in a library and recalled on later projects. A bundled application called 'Puzzle' lets you create cool rollovers and 3D vector extrusions to add pizzazz to your vector-based animations. With numerous new intelligent tools, CorelDRAW 11 is the best illustration application you can work with for fast and professional results.



CorelDRAW 11
Triffin Technologies, Ph: 011-6486447

The verdict: Integrating powerful new vector image manipulation capabilities, support for user-created macros for accessing often-used commands, this is the most comprehensive and powerful software for vector illustrations

